

**Section 1 (Please tell us about yourself - a brief description about your interest and hobbies?
(Maximum 300 words):**

I've always been the kind of person who finds joy in the small, quiet rhythms of life. Outside of academics, you'll most likely find me with a steaming cup of chai, lost in a paperback – usually a medical memoir or a collection of essays on public health disasters. Reading isn't just a hobby for me; it's how I process the world and remind myself why I want to be part of the solution, not just an observer.

But I don't stay indoors for long. Every weekend, I volunteer at a community kitchen near my neighborhood. That's where my real education happens – listening to people's stories between chopping vegetables and serving meals. You learn things there that no textbook teaches: how food insecurity shapes a child's future, or how loneliness can be a public health crisis in disguise.

When I need to clear my head, I go for long, aimless walks – sometimes with a podcast on mental health, sometimes just with my own thoughts. I've also picked up amateur gardening. It sounds odd, but watching seeds turn into saplings taught me more about patience and systemic thinking than any lecture ever could. You can't rush growth – you just create the right conditions and trust the process.

So yes, my hobbies are modest: reading, serving, walking, planting. But they've shaped a quiet obsession in me – understanding how people's daily environments affect their health. And that, honestly, is why I'm here, applying for this MPH.

Section 2 (Describe how the scholarship will enable you to access your desired Aston postgraduate programme, which may not have been possible without the financial support? (Maximum 300 words):

Let me be honest with you — without this scholarship, Aston wouldn't feel like a real possibility. It would feel like a beautiful dream I'm afraid to touch.

I come from a background where higher education abroad has always been seen as a luxury, not a next step. My family supports me with everything they have — emotionally, morally, endlessly — but financially, they simply cannot carry the weight of international tuition and living costs. And I've never wanted them to. That's why I've worked since my undergraduate days, saved what I could, and avoided asking for more than they can give.

But here's the quiet truth I've learned: hard work alone doesn't open every door. Sometimes, you need a hand — not because you're incapable, but because the system wasn't built for people like you.

This scholarship would be that hand. It wouldn't just pay fees; it would unlock access to Aston's MPH programme — access to world-class faculty, to research on health inequalities, to a network of peers who think globally and act locally. Without it, I'd likely spend the next few years piecing together affordable online courses, hoping they somehow add up to the kind of rigorous training Aston offers.

But with it? I could stand in a lecture hall, ask real questions, collect real data, and return home not just with a degree — but with the tools to rebuild something meaningful in my own community.

So no, this isn't about comfort or convenience. It's about access. And access changes everything.

Section 3 (What are your career aspirations post study and how will the intended postgraduate Aston programme open your job opportunities? (Maximum 300 words)):

I don't just want a job after this degree. I want a mission.

Long term, I see myself working at the intersection of public health policy and grassroots implementation — ideally with an international organization like the WHO, UNICEF, or a national health ministry, designing interventions that actually reach the people who need them most. I'm particularly drawn to infectious disease surveillance and maternal health programmes in under-resourced settings. These aren't abstract interests to me; they're problems I've watched tear through my own neighbourhood.

But here's what I've realized: passion without proper training only takes you so far.

The Aston MPH programme is my bridge. Why? Because Aston doesn't just teach theory — it emphasizes applied epidemiology, health data analysis, and real-world programme evaluation. Those are the exact skills employers in global health are starving for. When I graduate, I won't just walk into interviews with a certificate. I'll walk in with the ability to interpret outbreak data, design cost-effective interventions, and communicate findings to both policymakers and communities.

Specifically, Aston's connections with public health bodies in the West Midlands and beyond mean I'll have access to placements and projects that turn classroom knowledge into portfolio-ready experience. That's what opens job doors — not just the degree, but the proof that you've already done the work.

Short term after graduation? I hope to secure a role as a public health officer or research associate, ideally with an NGO or government body. Long term? I want to lead programmes that don't just treat sickness — but prevent it before it starts.

Aston won't just give me a qualification. It will give me credibility, competence, and a network. And that's how I'll turn aspirations into actual job offers.